

# MISSISSIPPI OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

---

Claim the exemption · Find out who inspects · Build it right

Project Address: \_\_\_\_\_

City / Town (if any): \_\_\_\_\_

County: \_\_\_\_\_

Code Status (see MS.4): \_\_\_\_\_

Owner-Builder: \_\_\_\_\_

Permit Application Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Every Mississippi statute, threshold, and requirement in this kit  
is cited on the page it appears on — verified August 2026.

**BUILD YOUR HOUSE**

[build-your-house.com](http://build-your-house.com)

First Edition — 2026

# How to Use This Kit

Five working documents, from "am I allowed to do this?" to the certificate of occupancy.

Mississippi is one of the easiest states in the country to build your own home in: a broad licensing exemption, no state permit, and across much of the state no building code enforced on your parcel at all.

That last point is the one that trips people up. Whether a code binds your land was not decided by your county's population or how rural it looks. **It was decided by a resolution entered on a board's minutes — in 2006 for the coast, in 2014 for everyone else — and both windows are long closed.** You cannot change that answer, only find out what it is. MS.4 shows you how.

## WHAT IS IN THE KIT

### The five documents

|             | Document                            | What it does for you                                                                                                                               |
|-------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>MS.1</b> | Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough | Whether you qualify, the one-per-year rule that is stricter than it looks, and the zero-dollar rule for everyone you hire. <b>Read this first.</b> |
| <b>MS.2</b> | Permit Application Checklist        | What to gather before you file — and what still applies when there is no building permit to file at all.                                           |
| <b>MS.3</b> | Inspection Sequence                 | The order inspections happen in, what each one checks, and what to do about it if nobody is coming.                                                |
| <b>MS.4</b> | Where to File Directory             | How to establish whether <i>any</i> code binds your parcel, who to ask, and a page to write down what you confirmed.                               |
| <b>MS.5</b> | Forms & Documents Index             | Each document you will meet: what it is, when, and from where.                                                                                     |

## HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with MS.1.** The exemption is yours and it is strong — but it runs on a rolling twelve months, not a calendar year, and it covers nobody you hire.
- **Then do MS.4 — before anything else practical.** Elsewhere the directory is a convenience; in Mississippi it settles whether you have a permit process at all.
- **Work MS.2 with a pen.** The approvals that are not building permits — septic, flood, driveway, power — apply in far more of Mississippi than the building code does.
- **Keep MS.3 on the job.** If no inspector is coming, it tells you what to buy instead.

**How these facts were checked.** Every Mississippi claim in this kit was read against its primary source in August 2026 — the Mississippi Code, the enacted bills as passed by the Legislature, and the State Board of Contractors' own published law and rules — and is cited on the page where it appears. Where the answer depends on your county, the kit says so and tells you how to find out. This is a process reference, not legal advice.